MSME PROVIDES IMPETUS T



> Uttar Pradesh contributes more than 8% to the country's GDP. To fulfill the Prime Minister's goal of making the country's economy five trillion dollars, Uttar Pradesh has resolved to become a trillion-dollar economy in the next five years. The state government is constantly striving and committed for development in the MSME sector.
>
> *—Yogi Adityanath, Chief Minister, UP*

Taking inspiration from Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath initiated schemes to foster the growth of Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in 2018. During that time, among the 75 districts in the state, 57 possessed unique products. The focus was directed toward promoting the special products of those districts, while a comprehensive program was designed to identify and promote specific products of the remaining 18 districts.

In a groundbreaking move, Uttar Pradesh became the first state in the country to introduce the innovative "One District, One Product" (ODOP) scheme, which has now evolved into a renowned brand across the nation. With this, about 96 lakh MSME units of the state have become the basis of life, employment, and self-reliance for crores of people. As a result of this, a remarkable 52 MSME products have received the GI Tag, which is the highest in the country.

From February 10 to 12, 2023, the "UP Global Investors Summit" took place in the state capital, Lucknow, showcasing a remarkable display of opportunities and potential in Uttar Pradesh. Through this, investment proposals worth more than Rs 36 lakh crore have been received so far. The tremendous response can be attributed to various factors that make Uttar Pradesh an attractive investment destination—the state's impressive "Ease of Doing Business" environment, robust law and order situation, use of technology,, and large base of MSMEs in the state. These factors have garnered significant interest from both national and international investors, all eager to connect with the immense opportunities the state has to offer. The state government is constantly making efforts to take these possibilities forward.

FACILITIES TO ENTREPRENEURS

In the MSME policy of the Yogi government, the state government has given a 1000 days exemption to the entrepreneur to start production and complete the processes by setting up an MSME unit. This entire process has been made online, ensuring ease and efficiency for aspiring business owners. To ensure smooth implementation, all concerned offices have been assigned specific responsibilities, streamlining the process further.

In a significant development, the Yogi government is actively working on the construction of the country's first "Unity Mall" at Awadh Shilpgram in Lucknow. Anticipated to be completed within this year, the Unity Mall aims to provide a dedicated space for entrepreneurs, offering special facilities to business owners coming from all corners of the country. Additionally, the project includes the construction of guest houses and hostels to cater to the needs of these entrepreneurs during their stay. Similarly, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath has given instructions to the officials to open Unity Malls in Varanasi and Agra.

